



INTERNATIONAL MBA RANKINGS

FINANCIAL TIMES

2007	2006	2005
1 Wharton School, US		
2 Columbia Business School, US		
3 Harvard Business School, US		
3 Stanford Grad School, US		
5 London Business School, UK		
6 Chicago Grad School, US		
7 INSEAD, France/Singapore		
8 Stern School, New York, US		
9 Tuck School of Business, US		
Yale School of Management, US		

BUSINESSWEEK

2006	2004	2002
1 Queen's University, Canada		
2 W. Ontario University, Canada		
3 Toronto University, Canada		
4 IMD, Switzerland		
5 London Business School, UK		
6 INSEAD, France		
7 ESADE, Barcelona, Spain		
8 IESE, Barcelona, Spain		
9 York University, Canada		
HEC, Montreal, Canada		

WALL STREET JOURNAL

2006	2005	2004
1 ESADE, Barcelona, Spain		
2 IMD, Switzerland		
3 IPADE, Mexico, US		
4 London Business School, UK		
5 Thunderbird Mgt School, US		
6 Columbia Business School, US		
7 ITESM-EGADE, Mexico, US		
8 Sloan School of Business, US		
9 W. Ontario University, Canada		
INCAE, Costa Rica		

* While FT and WSJ conduct annual surveys, the global MBA survey conducted by BW is biennial. The 2007 rankings of WSJ are awaited. For more details refer to <http://rankings.ft.com> and www.carrierjournal.com/reports/b-school06. IPADE: Instituto Panamericano de Alta Dirección de Empresa, IMD: International Institute for Management, ESADE: Escuela Superior de Administración y Dirección de Empresas, INCAE: Instituto Centroamericano de Administración de Empresas, ITESM-EGADE: Instituto Tecnológico de Estudios Superiores de Monterrey-Escuela de Graduados en Administración y Dirección de Empresas

what it used to be. The focus is on training the right entrepreneurs and not just the right managers and administrators. If Tuck's Cohen leadership programme imparts "the ability to inspire others to strive and enable them to accomplish great things", Columbia Business School's brand new programme in Social Intelligence will bring the benefits of the social sciences to business studies. MBA programmes around the world are keeping pace with the concerns of the 21st century—equity and access, poverty eradication, lifting the bottom lines and incubating leadership skills in an increasingly borderless world.

Richard Schmalensee, former dean of the Sloan School of Business, says that the school focuses on equipping leaders with the tools they need to drive change. "Very few of my colleagues have taught the same course twice," he adds, speaking of the need to keep pace with innovation. With businesses changing more rapidly than the MBA course curricula, are there any basic ingredients in this huge platter of goodies being served up by

B-schools round the globe? Schmalensee says the basic courses are important. Illustrative topics like case studies, on the other hand, are constantly 'phased in' and 'phased out' in keeping with the flavour of the times. Management institutes now want to offer a course that will be useful 20 years later, not just for the next interview.

David Oliver Standen, associate director of admissions at the Spanish Instituto de Empresa, refers to today's MBA as a "brute camp". Defending its relevance and apparent longevity, Standen says not all people are natural entrepreneurs, and an MBA hones their skills. What is more, it also gives you an enviable pay package. *The Wall Street Journal* has found that on average, the pre-MBA salary in Central Europe is \$20,000 (Rs 8 lakh), which shoots up to \$49,000 (Rs 20 lakh) right after an MBA. In Asia, the pre-MBA salary is \$35,000 (Rs 14 lakh) and the post-MBA starting salary is \$69,000 (Rs 28 lakh). The contrast is even more glaring in the US and

the UK, where pre-MBA salaries are around \$42,000 (Rs 17 lakh) and post-MBA, they hover around \$78,000 (Rs 31 lakh).

If you're wondering which programme to go for, global MBA programmes have as many points of distinction as they have commonalities. The variations lie in the fingerprint—research methodologies, pedagogic tools, technological inputs and, of course, the cost. Schools like Wharton, Harvard and Stanford cost around \$34,000 (Rs 13.5 lakh) per annum whereas in Europe, tuition costs could range between \$9,000-\$42,000 (Rs 4-Rs 17 lakh).

The duration of the course might also vary from one country to the other. European programmes tend to be shorter—most are only a year long. They also prefer work experience so that the semester on business fundamentals is kept optional. European schools have a wider spread of specialised MBAs whereas American MBAs tend to be more generalised, with students majoring in the second year. So take your pick from the very best. ■